

TPB ISP

Those behind The Pirate Bay launches an ISP; currently 100 subscribers are said to be using it

Windows 7 SP1

Microsoft to release the first service pack for Windows 7 in early 2011

Mobile watch

Microsoft kills its Kin, just 6 weeks after the launch

Against all expectations, Microsoft announced the discontinuation of its social networking mobile phone, Kin, just 6 weeks after its release into the market. Much to the dismay of Windows Phone 7 and social networking phone lovers, it has brought down an appalling gloom of darkness shrouded in mystery. The official reason is that the Kin core team would be moved into Windows Phone 7 project to allow Microsoft to concentrate to a promising

project. Microsoft also said they will be "incorporating valuable ideas and technologies from the Kin into future Windows Phone releases." A good idea, because some UI features of the Kin, such as Studio, Spot, and Loop, were surely interesting.

Other revelations indicate that Microsoft encountered several constraints & severe financial setbacks running the Kin project, including an unexpectedly feeble response in Kin's opening sales, amounting to just 500 Kin phones. Another major blow that Microsoft could not sustain, came



in the form of Verizon's exorbitant service charges on the monthly plan, which mirroring its luxury smartphone service plans.

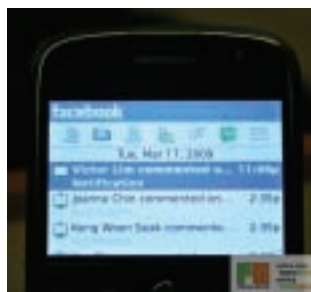
Though Microsoft has promised to continue pro-

viding support to existing Kin consumers, there is no word regarding the prospects of regular software updates & bug-fixes they'd highlighted earlier.

Free Facebook access to Airtel customers

Airtel has announced that it will offer free access to mobile Facebook users (comprising more than 130 million subscribers) on its network up to August 31st, 2010. The mobile Facebook version will enable users to post status updates, comment and write on walls, message others, and also be able to view or upload photos (without incurring any data charges on this usage). Existing mobile internet users on Airtel can immediately avail of this free service by connecting to their friends on the mobile Facebook site. However, the

new subscribers who are accessing the mobile internet for the first time need to SMS FACEBOOK to 54321 to make use of this offer. Airtel promises to offer Facebook in six Indian languages - Hindi, Punjabi, Bengali, Telugu, Tamil, and Malayalam, starting with Hindi and English.



Cheap Android phones aimed at India

Google is looking to expand the offering of the Android OS, and has aggressively taken aim at emerging markets, such as India and China, with cheaper handsets catering to the untapped masses. Andy Rubin, vice president for Engineering at Google, recently commented about the potential of these markets: "the down-market opportunity is about to happen. It's actually quite a revolution".

Apart from low cost handsets, Google intends to provide payment gateways

for application developers, allowing them easily accept payments and sell things like subscriptions. Low-cost handset makers have already started making noises about their upcoming Android devices, such as Huawei, LG, and Samsung.

Lemon Mobiles, a relatively recent entrant into the Indian mobile market, has also announced a low-cost Android 1.6 mobile, called the P1, which stands for Professional One. In related news, Reliance will also be launching the first Android CDMA phone in India - the Samsung Galaxy i899.